

Si Wu 吴斯

siwu1@bu.edu | <https://si-wu.com/> | September 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Comparative politics, demography, labor, political economy, development, gender, China, mixed-method research design

DISSERTATION

From Control to Choice: Women, Work, and Power in China's New Birth Planning Regime

COMPREHENSIVE EXAMS

Comparative Politics, Political Methodology (Passed in September 2022)

EDUCATION

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| • Boston University, PhD in Political Science, Boston, MA. | Sept. 2020 – Aug. 2026 |
| • Northeastern University, MA in Journalism, Boston, MA. | Jan. 2018 – May 2020 |
| • Durham University, Postgraduate Certificate in Education, Durham, U.K. | Sept. 2016 – June 2017 |
| • Imperial College London, BSc in Physics, London, U.K. | Sept. 2013 – June 2016 |

PUBLICATIONS

Market Reform and Gender Norms: How the End of China's One-Child Policy Reshaped Women's Employment in State and Private Sectors (Job Market Paper).

- Key words: gender norms; workforce participation; one-child policy; economic reforms; Chinese politics.

[Summer in the Field: Women, Work and Politics in China's New Era of Family Planning](#) (October 2023). *BU Global Development Policy Center*.

- Key words: political economy; gender inequality; family planning; one-child policy.

Geometry of Graph Partitions via Optimal Transport (October 2020). *SIAM Journal on Scientific Computing*. (With Tara Abrishami, Nestor Guillen, Parker Rule, Zachary Schutzman, Justin Solomon, and Thomas Weighill). ArXiv: [1910.09618](#).

- Key words: political districting plans; partitions; optimal transport; network flows.

[Democrats 'went low' on Twitter leading up to 2018](#) (February 2019). *Roll Call*. (With Aleszu Bajak).

- Key words: Twitter data; sentiment analysis; machine learning; Senate candidates.

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS (*denotes funding not included in the standard PhD package)

Boston University, the Center for Innovation in Social Science (CISS), Dissertation Honorable Mention Award (\$1,000)*	2025
Boston University, The Frederick S. Pardee Center for the Study of the Longer-Range Future, Graduate Summer Fellowship (\$6,500)*	2024

Boston University, Graduate School of Arts & Sciences, Graduate Research Abroad Fellowship (\$6,000)*	2023
Boston University, Global Development Policy Center, Summer in the Field Fellowship (\$6,000)*	2023
Boston University, Hariri Institute for Computing, Graduate Student Fellowship (\$7,500)*	2020
Boston University, Dean's Fellowship	2020-2021
Northeastern University, Graduate Student Scholarship (\$12,897)	2018-2020

WORKING PAPERS

Market Reform and Gender Norms: How the End of China's One-Child Policy Reshaped Women's Employment in Private and State Sectors

- Presented at: Boston University, APSA 2024, MPSA 2023, Harvard-MIT-BU Chinese Politics Research Workshop, EGEN

From Reproduction to Protection? Shifting Discourses of the All-China Women's Federation on Birth Planning and Domestic Violence

- Presented at: Harvard-MIT-BU Chinese Politics Research Workshop, AAS 2026, APSA 2026

The End of China's One-Child Policy and Gendered Labor Dynamics: A Sectoral Comparison Across Education, E-Commerce, Finance, and Transportation and Logistics (With Roselyn Hsueh)

- Presented at: APSA 2025, APSA 2026

Examining the Political Geography of the Gender Gap: The Case of Guangzhou, China

- Presented at AAS 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor, Boston University May 2025 – June 2025

- Served as the course instructor for Data Science for Politics.

Teaching Fellow, Boston University Sept. 2021 – Dec. 2025

- Served as a Teaching Fellow for the following courses: Introduction to Comparative Politics; Introduction to International Relations; Data Science for Politics; Introduction to Public Policy.

Racial Policy Tracker, Center for Antiracist Research at Boston University June 2021 – Aug. 2021

- Analyzed COVID mortality data with modelling techniques.
- Collected data on minority representation in U.S. politics.

Data Visualization Intern, Harvard Data Science Initiative Sept. 2019 – Dec. 2019

- Developed data visualizations to effectively communicate data science concepts.
- Helped with conference planning and website design for the Harvard Data Science Review Inaugural Symposium.

Data Science Research Fellow, MIT/Tufts University June 2019 – Aug. 2019

- Researched for the Metric Geometry and Gerrymandering Group (MGGG Redistricting Lab).
- Coauthored "Geometry of Graph Partitions via Optimal Transport" in *SIAM Journal on Scientific Computing*.
- Compiled figures with census data and GIS shapefiles by applying math techniques such as Markov Chain Monte Carlo, multi-objective optimization, transport distances and network.
- Developed JavaScript projects for data visualization and outreach.

Researcher, Northeastern's School of Journalism

April 2018 – May 2019

- Collected Twitter and Reddit data with Python and R.
- Applied machine learning techniques on tweets from midterm election candidates to predict positive/negative sentiment.

CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association (APSA), Boston, MA	Sept. 2026
Association for Asian Studies (AAS) (Panel Organizer), Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada	March 2026
Research in Comparative Politics (RCP) Workshop, Department of Political Science, Boston University, Boston, MA	Sept. 2025
American Political Science Association (APSA), Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada	Sept. 2025
Topics in Politics (TIPS) Workshop, Department of Political Science, Boston University, Boston, MA	April 2025
Association for Asian Studies (AAS), Columbus, OH	March 2025
Harvard-MIT-BU Chinese Politics Research Workshop, Center for Government and International Studies, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA	April 2022; Oct. 2023; Nov. 2024
American Political Science Association (APSA), Philadelphia, PA	Sept. 2024
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA), Chicago, IL	April 2023
The Empirical Study of Gender Research Network (EGEN), Harvard Kennedy School, Cambridge, MA	Sept. 2022
Northeastern University Visualization Consortium (NUVis), Boston, MA	Dec. 2018

SERVICE

The Frederick S. Pardee Center for the Study of the Longer-Range Future, Boston University	2025
• Graduate Summer Fellowship Application Reviewer	
Topics in Politics (TIPS) Workshop, BU Department of Political Science	2024 – 2025
• Organizing Committee Member	
Harvard-MIT-BU Chinese Politics Research Workshop	2022 – 2025
• BU Coordinator	
Hariri Institute for Computing, Boston University	2020 – 2022
• “Did you know you could...?” series co-coordinator and host	

MEDIA COVERAGE

Graduate School of Arts & Sciences, Boston University	July 2023
• “Doctoral students return home for summer research”	
Hariri Institute for Computing, Boston University	April 2021
• “Graduate Student Fellow Hopes to Apply Data Journalism Skills to Study Inequalities”	
College of Arts, Media and Design, Northeastern University	Nov. 2019
• “Si Wu, Journalism Graduate Student, Uses Data to Help Others Understand Political Redistricting”	
News@Northeastern, Northeastern University	March 2019
• “Democrats who won 2018 midterms were more negative than Republicans on Twitter, research finds”	

INVITED TALKS & GUEST LECTURES

Guest Lecture, Qualitative Methods (Professor Rosella Cappella Zielinski)	Nov. 2024
The Frederick S. Pardee Center for the Study of the Longer-Range Future, Graduate Summer Fellow Lightning Talk	Oct. 2024
Hariri Institute for Computing, Graduate Student Alumni and Networking Event	Sept. 2023
Guest Lecture, Data Science for Politics (Professor Maxwell Palmer)	Dec. 2023
Guest Lecture, Introduction to Public Policy (Dr. Rachel Meade)	April 2022

FIELD RESEARCH

Shenzhen, Zhuhai, Guangzhou, Zhaoqing, Yunfu, Meizhou, Chaozhou in Guangdong, China; Beijing, China	2023-2024
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SKILLS

- Languages: English (fluent in speaking, reading, writing), Chinese (native in speaking, reading, writing, and in both Mandarin and Cantonese), Korean (beginner).
- Computing Skills: Python, R, GIS, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, and LaTeX.

REFERENCES

Taylor C. Boas

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Department of Political Science
Boston University
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Rachel Brulé

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Frederick S. Pardee School of Global Studies
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